INCH-POUND

A-A-20131A
May 12, 1993
SUPERSEDING
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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

CHERRIES, MARASCHINO, PITTED, RED

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description in preference to Federal Specification Y-C-2083.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers pitted maraschino cherries without stems, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government

Salient characteristics.

The product shall be prepared from properly matured, sound, clean, whole cherries (Prunus avium or Prunus cerasus) which are properly bleached, pitted, and colored. The cherries shall be packed in a syrup solution and processed to insure preservation. The syrup at time of "cut out" (not earlier than 7 days after packing) shall not be less than 37° Brix at 20°C. The product shall have a distinct, characteristic maraschino cherry flavor and odor. The color shall be a uniform characteristic red maraschino cherry color. The red color shall be achieved by using any of the food colors currently certified and approved by the Food and Drug Administration. Natural and/or artificial flavoring ingredients of the type and quantity used in the manufacture of maraschino cherries may be added. Calcium chloride, citric acid, potassium sorbate, and sodium benzoate may also be used. Unless otherwise specified, cherries used for this product shall be from the latest season's pack.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.

FSC 8915

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Except for color, the maraschino cherries shall meet the requirements for U.S. Grade A, stemmed and pitted style, of the United States Standards for Grades of Sulfured Cherries.

The cherries shall be of the following sizes when specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Size	Minimum diameter 1/	Maximum diameter 2/
Size I - Medium	18 mm	20 mm
Size II - Large	20 mm	22 mm
Size III - Extra large	22 mm	larger

1/ Not more than 10 percent, by weight, of all the cherries are smaller than the designated size; provided no more than 1 percent, by weight, are more than 2 mm smaller than the designated size.

2/ Not more than 10 percent, by weight, of all the cherries are larger than the designated size; provided no more than 1 percent, by weight, are more than 2 mm larger than the designated size.

The minimum drained weight of the product shall be not less than the following:

Container size	Minimum drained weight
16 ounces net weight (453.6 g)	9.5 ounces (269.3 g)
128 fluid ounces (3,785.4 mL)	5 pounds, 10 ounces (2,551.5 g)

The drained weight of the maraschino cherries shall be determined by emptying the contents of the container on an 8-inch or 12-inch diameter U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve, allowing the sieve to drain for 2 minutes in an inclined position at a 17° to 20° angle, and calculating the weight of the cherries by subtracting the weight of the dry sieve

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID; conforms to the producer's own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories or possessions; and is sold on the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at

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final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product in the commercial marketplace. Delivered product shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

Quality assurance.

When the solicitation, contract, or purchase order requires that product quality or acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, shall be the certifying activity and shall make the determination in accordance with applicable PPB provisions. The product shall be examined or analyzed or both in accordance with applicable provisions in the CID, and when applicable, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The maraschino cherries shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and cases marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable

For Department of Defense procurements (Only).

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packaging. Sixteen ounces (453.6 g) of product shall be packaged in a glass jar in accordance with good commercial practice.

B. Commercial packing. Twelve or twenty-four jars of product shall be packed in a single layer in a container complying with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

C. Commercial unit loads. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type III, Class G of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping

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D. Export packaging. Sixteen ounces (453.6 g) of product shall be packaged in a glass jar with a metal closure. The inside of the closure shall have a suitable compound to effect an hermetic seal.

E. Export packing. Twelve or twenty-four jars of product shall be packed in a single layer in a shipping container constructed in accordance with Style RSC-L, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Pads shall be placed on the top and on the bottom of the jars. Each shipping container shall be provided with partitions that separate the glass jars from each other. The partition shall be the same height as the container and provide a cell for each jar. The pads and partitions shall be of fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, Grade W6c, Flute A or C.

F. Export unit loads. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type I, Class A of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping

G. Labeling (commercial and export). Labeling of jars shall be in accordance with good commercial practice and be in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

H. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Notes.

Purchasers should specify:

- Size of product required.
- Size and type of packaging.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road
Alexandria, VA 22314

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Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1-199. This three-volume set may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents at (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and copies of the United States Standards for Grades of Sulfured Cherries are available from:

Chief
Processed Products Branch
Fruit and Vegetable Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 0709, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from·

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

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Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section D
700 Robbins Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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